

in current versions. However, they too will not be able to permanently delay the update, unless (ironically) Microsoft decides to add such a feature in a future update.

Unsurprisingly, this decision has been met with serious derision from the tech community, in particular, app developers. Some may argue that by ensuring all systems are updated, developers can ensure their apps will remain compatible for all users. The other side of this coin is that updates can also cause certain apps to break. Developers can no longer rest with the knowledge of creating an app that will not fail as a result of factors out of their control. Upgrade only if you are willing to live the constant risk of an essential app breaking functionality, and waiting till (hopefully) a fix is released.

No support for SecuROM and SafeDisc DRM

Microsoft has stated that games using old, unsupported DRMs such as SecuROM and SafeDisc will not be supported on Windows 10. These DRMs have not been supported for years and their drivers have consequently been left unupdated. These drivers pose a “possible loophole for computer viruses” according to Microsoft’s German Marketing Manager, Boris Schneider-Johne, and hence any software requiring the use of these drivers will not work.

These DRMs were well known for the sheer inconvenience they caused in the name of keeping games free from piracy. For example, SecuROM restricted the number of times you could reinstall a game while also forcing occasional online authenticity checks. In actuality, these did very little to actually prevent piracy; instead, even gamers who owned legitimate copies of these games would use a crack or noCD patch to override the DRM.

If some of your old favourites use these DRMs, you can still play them on Windows 10, provided you avoid the DRM. Some developers have re-released DRM-free versions of their games on sites like GOG.com. Of course, you could always download a crack or noCD patch that circumvents the DRM. If you’re not comfortable downloading cracks/patches (considering the malware risk it carries), a legal and relatively safer option would be test-signing the DRM software’s drivers yourself. You can refer to Microsoft’s DIY tutorial (<http://dgit.in/TestSignMSFT>) or use a third-party software to do it with a few clicks (<http://dgit.in/NGOHQ>). This process does leave a Windows watermark, though there are tutorials to help you remove that as well (<http://dgit.in/Compuzo>). 